MzansiRide SafeAI: Two-Presenter Script

Progress review · AWS AI Hackathon 2026 · follows the 26-slide Monday Deck

How to use this script

This script covers every slide, shows who speaks and when, and totals about 20 minutes. Magala is the first speaker. Nhlanhla presents the architecture, the frontend, the AWS implementation, the working prototype, the outstanding work and the expected impact. Lines in bold are handovers. Lines in italics are cues that are not spoken. Say “simulated” and “illustrative” aloud wherever they apply, since the requirements reward honesty about what is real.

Magala speaks for about 10½ minutes and Nhlanhla for about 10.

Running order at a glance

#	Slide	Speaker	Length	Starts at
1	Cover	Magala	0:20	0:00
2	Picture this	Magala	0:30	0:20
3	What we’ll cover	Magala	0:15	0:50
4	Safety shouldn’t depend on a button	Magala	1:00	1:05
5	Proactive, not reactive	Magala	0:30	2:05
6	Who it’s for	Magala	0:30	2:35
7	How it works	Magala	0:45	3:05
8	A check-in, not an alarm	Magala	0:40	3:50
9	WhatsApp: a safety line	Magala	0:40	4:30
10	If you don’t answer	Magala	0:45	5:10
11	Know your driver before you get in	Magala	0:40	5:55
12	Safer and cheaper	Magala	0:40	6:35
13	How we built it on AWS	Nhlanhla	1:15	7:15
14	Built to be responsible	Nhlanhla	0:30	8:30

#	Slide	Speaker	Length	Starts at
15	Request a ride, see the saving	Nhlanhla	0:30	9:00
16	Safe Journey Mode in action	Nhlanhla	0:30	9:30
17	Every trip leaves a record	Nhlanhla	0:30	10:00
18	What the operator sees	Nhlanhla	0:40	10:30
19	What the AI does, and doesn't	Magala	1:30	11:10
20	The AI assistant in action	Magala	0:40	12:40
21	Why each AWS service	Nhlanhla	1:00	13:20
22	Live demo	Nhlanhla	3:15	14:20
23	Working, simulated and still to come	Nhlanhla	0:40	17:35
24	Outstanding work	Nhlanhla	0:40	18:15
25	Expected impact	Nhlanhla	0:30	18:55
26	Closing	Magala	1:10	19:25

Opening

Slide 1 · Cover

Magala · 0:00 · about 20 seconds

"Good day. I'm Magala, and this is Nhlanhla. We're presenting MzansiRide SafeAI: a safety intelligence platform for ride operators, built for passengers in South Africa. I'll take you through the problem and our solution. Nhlanhla will cover the architecture and the frontend. I'll come back for the AI, and then Nhlanhla will explain our AWS implementation and run the live demo before I close."

Cue: don't linger on this slide.

Slide 2 · Picture this

Magala · 0:20 · about 30 seconds

"Imagine you're in the back of a ride at night. The car stops somewhere you don't recognise. Is it a detour? A phone call? Something worse?"

[Pause.]

“Now imagine finding your phone, opening an app and pressing the right button, while your heart is racing.”

[Pause.]

“A panic button asks you to act in the hardest moment of your journey. We asked a different question: what if the system noticed first? This is MzansiRide SafeAI.”

Cue: speak slowly and let the last line land before you move on.

Slide 3 · What we’ll cover

Magala · 0:50 · about 15 seconds

“Here’s our route: the problem, our solution, the architecture and security, the frontend, the AI integration, our AWS implementation, the working prototype, and what’s still outstanding. Nhlanhla and I will share it, and we’ll tell you when we swap.”

The problem

Slide 4 · Safety shouldn’t depend on a button

Magala · 1:05 · about 60 seconds

“Let’s start with why this matters. For millions of South Africans, especially women travelling alone, getting into a car with an unfamiliar driver is a calculation made on every trip. Students and daily commuters worry about unexpected stops, route changes, and whether anyone they trust knows where they are.

Today’s answer is the panic button, and it has three weaknesses. It is reactive: it only works if you’re able to press it. It is blunt: every unusual event looks the same. And it is invisible to the operator, who often learns about an incident when a complaint arrives, not when it begins.

Cost matters too. Students and commuters need cheaper travel, and shared rides can help, but only if people feel safe sharing.

So we asked one question: how can AI and cloud technology detect a problem early, support the passenger, and give the operator visibility, without ever assuming the worst about anyone?”

Cue: add a statistic only if you can name its source aloud.

Our solution

Slide 5 · Proactive, not reactive

Magala · 2:05 · about 30 seconds

“We didn’t set out to build a better panic button. The difference is who acts first. On the left, a typical panic button needs you to notice, find it and press it. On the right, our system watches the trip data for you, checks in on WhatsApp with a single tap, uses rules to detect and AI to explain, and gives the operator a live view. Proactive, not reactive.”

Slide 6 · Who it’s for

Magala · 2:35 · about 30 seconds

“We built this for six groups: women and vulnerable passengers who want extra safety support; students who need affordable transport; daily commuters; budget-conscious passengers interested in shared rides; drivers, whose details and trip status passengers can see; and transport operators, who gain clearer visibility of trips and alerts. In this prototype, every passenger and driver profile is simulated, not real people’s information.”

Slide 7 · How it works

Magala · 3:05 · about 45 seconds

“Here’s how it works. One: the passenger requests a ride, sees the driver and vehicle, and switches on Safe Journey Mode. Two: rules watch the trip for a long unexpected stop or a big route deviation. Three: when a rule fires, we check in on WhatsApp and in the app: ‘Are you safe? Reply 1 for yes, 2 for help.’ Four: if she replies help, or doesn’t reply, the system escalates. Five: the operator sees it on a live dashboard with an AI summary, and everything is recorded.

We never assume the driver is acting maliciously. A stop can have an innocent explanation, so the passenger is always asked first. In the prototype, the stops and deviations are simulated.”

Slide 8 · A check-in, not an alarm

Magala · 3:50 · about 40 seconds

“We chose WhatsApp for three reasons. It works outside our app, so nothing needs to be opened. It’s already on every phone, with no extra app to install. And it asks for one tap, not a search for a button in a crisis. Reply 1 and the alert closes. Reply 2, or no reply, and escalation begins. Silence is recorded as a fact, never as a conclusion.”

Cue: the message on screen is an example. Don’t say WhatsApp needs no mobile data.

Slide 9 · WhatsApp: a safety line, not just an alert

Magala · 4:30 · about 40 seconds

“WhatsApp isn’t only where alerts arrive. It’s a two-way channel on a real number. A passenger can type CHECK to look up a driver, which is simulated, TRIP to link the chat to her trip, STATUS to see it, SOS to alert her trusted contact, or 1 or 2 to answer a check-in. Or she can simply describe her situation and our AI assistant guides her. We’ll show that assistant in the AI section.”

Slide 10 · If you don’t answer

Magala · 5:10 · about 45 seconds

“A fair question: what happens if you don’t answer? Here is the workflow. The check-in goes out on WhatsApp and in the app. A wait window follows, and the operator sets how long. If there’s no reply, or she sends a 2, her trusted contact is messaged. The operator’s screen turns red with the AI’s one-line next step. Then a person acts: the operator calls the driver, and everything is logged.

Reply 1 at any point and the alert closes. We never auto-call emergency services, and we never assume wrongdoing. People make those decisions.”

Cue: the slide is tagged “designed workflow”. If the timeout is built, say so. If not, say the wait window is still being finished.

Slide 11 · Know your driver before you get in

Magala · 5:55 · about 40 seconds

“We want passengers to know who is driving before they get in. At the start of every ride, the driver unlocks the app with Face ID or a fingerprint on their own phone. The passenger sees ‘Verified at the start of this ride’ or ‘Not verified’, and decides.

We’re honest about the limits. A phone biometric proves who unlocked the phone, not that they hold a licence, so a one-time ID check at sign-up is still needed. Drivers without a biometric phone show as ‘Not verified’. Face data stays on the driver’s phone, and we only receive a pass or a fail.

Cue: update the PLANNED tag if the check gets built.

Slide 12 · Safer and cheaper

Magala · 6:35 · about 40 seconds

“Now the part that makes a difference to the pocket. The same trip costs R67.50 alone. Share it with one other person and it’s R40.50 each. Share it with two others and it’s R27.00 each, which is 60 percent cheaper per rider. We show that saving before you book, right next to the safety check-ins, because sharing only works when people feel safe sharing. These fares are illustrative, from simple pricing rules, on a simulated trip.”

Handover: “That’s our solution. Nhlanhla will now show you how we built it.”

Cue: don’t claim that no competitor offers shared rides. Some do.

Architecture and security

Slide 13 · How we built it on AWS

Nhlanhla · 7:15 · about 75 seconds

“Thanks. Let me walk one alert through our architecture. We chose a serverless design on AWS, so it scales automatically and cost grows with use.

The React app is served through Amazon CloudFront, and it sends requests to Amazon API Gateway, our front door. API Gateway is also the webhook for WhatsApp: every message and reply from the passenger arrives here. It triggers AWS Lambda, the brain. Lambda runs the rule engine, sends the check-ins, handles escalation, and calls Amazon Bedrock, which returns the triage line, the explanation or the assistant’s answer. Amazon DynamoDB stores trips, alerts and the safety log, and Amazon CloudWatch records logs so we can trace every alert.

The red dashed line is the outbound side: check-ins and AI replies travel from Lambda back out to the passenger on WhatsApp. In one line: WhatsApp is how we reach the passenger, and API Gateway is how that conversation reaches our system.”

Cue: point to each box as you name it. If a service isn’t wired up yet, call it planned.

Slide 14 · Built to be responsible

Nhlanhla · 8:30 · about 30 seconds

“Security and privacy are designed in. We use simulated data only, so no real location data is collected. An unusual event is a prompt to check in, never proof of wrongdoing. The AI works only from approved safety information, and it is clearly not an emergency service: in danger, call 10111 or 112. We store minimal data, control access at the backend, and keep credentials out of the frontend. We’ve designed with POPIA in mind, and a production version would need a formal assessment.”

The frontend

Slide 15 · Request a ride, see the saving

Nhlanhla · 9:00 · about 30 seconds

“This is the working frontend. The passenger chooses a pickup and destination from predefined Johannesburg locations on real road routes, and sees the individual fare, R67.50 for this trip, next to the shared options: R40.50 with two riders and R27.00 with three. It’s marked simulated, and the fares are illustrative.”

Slide 16 · Safe Journey Mode in action

Nhlanhla · 9:30 · about 30 seconds

“Once the trip starts, Safe Journey Mode is on and watching for unusual stops and route changes. The passenger can see her trusted contact, share her trip, or send an SOS in one tap. The page says plainly that notifications are simulated unless the number is on our demo allow-list, so nothing here is hidden.”

Slide 17 · Every trip leaves a record

Nhlanhla · 10:00 · about 30 seconds

“When the trip ends, the summary shows the fare, the distance and the number of safety alerts, plus what sharing would have saved, about R27 on this trip. Below it, the safety log is stored in DynamoDB. On the right, the driver card says ‘demo driver, not verified’ and tells the passenger to check the plate, the car and the driver before getting in.”

Slide 18 · What the operator sees

Nhlanhla · 10:30 · about 40 seconds

“This is what the operator sees. Please note that this screen is an illustrative mock-up. Most trips are green. The one that needs attention turns red, with the AI’s one-line next step: stopped off-route, passenger unresponsive on WhatsApp, request an immediate driver voice call. Operators get live status, a clear next step instead of a raw alert, and a full record of every alert and response.”

Handover: “I’ll hand back to Magala to explain the AI.”

Cue: if you replace the mock-up with a real Fleet screenshot, delete the mock-up line.

AI integration

Slide 19 · What the AI does, and doesn't

Magala · 11:10 · about 90 seconds

"Thanks, Nhlanhla. Now the AI, and just as importantly, how we don't use it. We made one deliberate decision: detection and intelligence are separate.

Detection is rule-based. Deterministic rules decide whether an event has occurred, for example a stop beyond a set time and off the planned route. That makes the system predictable, testable and auditable, and we never let a language model decide whether someone is in danger.

Once a rule fires, the AI, running on Amazon Bedrock, does three jobs. It writes a one-line triage action for the fleet manager. It explains to the passenger, in calm plain language, what happened and what her options are. And it answers safety questions on WhatsApp and in the app, from approved guidance only.

Why AI? Because turning a raw event into a calm, clear sentence in seconds is exactly what language models do well.

And the limits: it never decides someone is in danger, never blames the driver or predicts crime, never claims a passenger is safe, and never replaces emergency services. Rules detect. AI explains. People decide."

Cue: if asked which model, name the Bedrock model you configured. If asked what happens when the AI is wrong: it never makes the safety decision.

Slide 20 · The AI assistant in action

Magala · 12:40 · about 40 seconds

"Here's the assistant in a real chat with our prototype number. When we asked what it can do, it explained that it only helps with trip safety and the app. When we asked about Uber, it stayed on topic, said this is a prototype with simulated trips, and said Uber is a different service. In danger, it points to 10111 or 112. It even greets in isiZulu.

People use it on WhatsApp by typing or replying 1 or 2, and in the app through the Assistant tab. Operators see the AI's one-line next step on the fleet dashboard."

Handover: "Nhlanhla will now explain why we chose each AWS service, and then show you the live demo."

AWS implementation

Slide 21 · Why each AWS service

Nhlanhla · 13:20 · about 60 seconds

“Thanks. Now let me explain why we chose each AWS service. CloudFront serves the app quickly and securely, with no web servers for us to run. API Gateway is the front door, including for WhatsApp, and it’s managed, secure and scales with traffic. Lambda runs our rules, check-ins, escalation and AI calls, and we pay only when it runs, so the same code serves one trip or a national fleet. Bedrock gives us foundation models as a service, with no model servers to build. DynamoDB stores trips, alerts and the safety log, fast and scalable, which gives operators their audit trail. CloudWatch lets us trace and prove what happened. And IAM gives each function only the access it needs.

It’s serverless throughout: we pay for what we use, and nothing sits idle.”

Cue: delete the row of any service you haven’t actually wired up before you present.

Working prototype

Slide 22 · Live demo: the main user journey

Nhlanhla · 14:20 · about 3 minutes 15 seconds

“Now let’s see it running. Here is the main user journey. One: I request a ride. Two: here’s the driver and vehicle, a labelled demo driver. Three: I switch on Safe Journey Mode. Four: I trigger a simulated stop.

Five: watch the phone. The check-in arrives on WhatsApp.” *[Hold up the phone. Reply 1, or deliberately don’t.]*

“Six: on the operator’s dashboard, the alert appears. Seven: finally, the shared-ride saving.

Remember: the trip and events are simulated, the WhatsApp number is real, and the assistant runs on Amazon Bedrock.”

Cue: if time allows, show the AWS console in this order: API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB, CloudWatch. Keep backup screenshots and a screen recording ready in case anything fails, and switch to them without apologising.

Slide 23 · Working, simulated and still to come

Nhlanhla · 17:35 · about 40 seconds

“Here’s an honest view of where we are. Working today: ride request and fare comparison; Safe Journey Mode with trusted contact, share trip and SOS; the two-way WhatsApp channel on a real number; the Amazon Bedrock safety assistant; and the safety log in DynamoDB. Simulated: trips and route events, driver profiles labelled as demos, and notifications unless the number is on the demo allow-list. Still to come: live GPS, driver verification, emergency-service integration, real payments, and a POPIA assessment with an operator pilot. We do not claim to prevent crime, guarantee safety or verify drivers.”

Outstanding work

Slide 24 · Outstanding work

Nhlanhla · 18:15 · about 40 seconds

“And here is the outstanding work we’re finishing before Tuesday’s hackathon: making the whole app mobile friendly and resizeable; an always-visible AI assistant button with instant one-tap answers; weekly and monthly fare calculations; sign-in with Amazon Cognito; the full no-reply workflow with an operator-set wait window; and a driver check with Face ID or a fingerprint at the start of each ride.”

Cue: update this slide and slide 23 to match what is built by presentation time.

Close

Slide 25 · Expected impact

Nhlanhla · 18:55 · about 30 seconds

“Three groups benefit. Passengers get calm, clear support and a one-tap check-in. Operators get real-time visibility, faster response and a record of every alert. Communities get cheaper shared travel: a trip at R67.50 alone drops to R27.00 each when three riders share. Those are illustrative fares.”

Handover: “I’ll hand back to Magala to close.”

Slide 26 · Closing

Magala · 19:25 · about 70 seconds

“Let’s go back to that car.” *[Pause for a full beat.]*

“It’s night. It has stopped somewhere you don’t recognise. In most apps today, what happens next depends on you finding a button.

In MzansiRide SafeAI, it doesn't. Your phone buzzes on WhatsApp: 'Are you safe? Reply 1 or 2.' One tap. And if you can't reply, that silence isn't ignored. The operator already has a clear next step on their screen, and every alert and response is on record.

What you've seen today isn't a mock-up of an idea. It's a working prototype on AWS: a real WhatsApp number, an assistant on Amazon Bedrock, and a safety log in DynamoDB. The trips and drivers are simulated, and we've said so on every screen.

Three things to remember. One: proactive, not reactive. We don't wait for the worst moment to ask someone to act. Two: rules detect, AI explains, people decide. The AI helps, and it never judges and never blames. Three: it's built to scale. It's serverless, so the same design serves one operator or a national fleet, and the cost grows only with use.

And safety isn't only about fear. It's about access. A student who shares a R67.50 ride and pays R27.00 is only willing to share if she feels safe doing it.

Our next steps are live route data, driver verification, a POPIA assessment, and a pilot with a real operator.

We're not asking anyone to hand their safety to AI. We're showing how AI can mean fewer passengers face that moment alone, and fewer operators find out too late.

Safety shouldn't depend on a button. Thank you."

Cue: slow down on the last sentence, say "Thank you" quietly, and add nothing after it.

If you run short

If the slot is shorter than 20 minutes, cut in this order. Each cut saves the time shown.

1. Slide 3, the agenda (15 seconds).
2. Slide 6, who it's for (30 seconds): fold one sentence into slide 4.
3. Slide 25, expected impact (30 seconds).
4. Slide 11, know your driver (40 seconds): mention it in one line on slide 24.
5. Slides 14 and 17 (60 seconds): say one line each.

These cuts save about 3 minutes. Keep slides 2, 13, 19, 22 and 26 in full.

Before you present

- Both of you read the whole script. The requirements say both members must be able to explain the entire project.
- Run the demo journey end to end once, and check that the WhatsApp number can message your phone.
- Open the AWS console tabs in advance, and avoid showing any secrets.

- Prepare the backup: screenshots of every step and a screen recording of the full journey.
- Update slides 10, 11, 18, 23 and 24 so they match exactly what is built on the day.
- Rehearse the four handovers (after slides 12, 18, 20 and 25) until they feel natural.